

83% of assessed businesses lack documented IT budgets.

— 2026 Trueline IT Assessment

Cost Categories

- 1. Hardware
- 2. Software Licenses
- 3. Cloud Services
- 4. Staff/Salaries
- 5. Support/Maintenance
- 6. Security
- 7. Backup/DR
- 8. Network
- 9. Training
- 10. Contingency

Common Budgeting Gaps

- ✗ No IT Budget
- ✗ All Reactive Spend
- ✗ Hidden Software Costs
- ✗ Vendor Lock-in
- ✗ License Waste
- ✗ No Contingency

10 Budgeting Steps

- 1. Audit Spending
- 2. Define Strategy
- 3. Forecast Needs
- 4. Research Costs
- 5. Plan Upgrades
- 6. Negotiate Contracts
- 7. Build Contingency
- 8. Track Spending
- 9. Quarterly Review
- 10. Adjust Forecast

Poor IT Budget Planning

- Unplanned major expenses derail operations
- License waste and overspend
- Delayed critical upgrades and security patches
- Inability to respond to business change

Get Your Budget Roadmap

Book your free 15-minute Trueline IT Health Score today.

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